

Publishing Guidelines for the FQ_xI Foundational Review

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Abstract

In these sets of notes, I detail the publication guidelines for the FQ_xI Foundational Review Series (FRS from hereon). In particular, I describe the main definitions used throughout the manuscript in Sec. 1, FQ_xI FRS scope and editorial criteria in Sec. 2, submission process and manuscript preparation in Sec. 3, peer-review process in Sec. 4, authorship in Sec. 5, and terms and conditions in Sec. 6. In the making of these guidelines, I used [Google's Gemini 3.5 Flash](#) for grammar and rephrasing.

1. Definitions

Firstly, whenever FRS is mentioned, FQ_xI is also implicitly mentioned, unless stated explicitly. Secondly, the definitions of the “user”, “work”, and “submitter”, detailed in this section are adapted and modified from the [Quantum Journal Terms and Conditions](#), available under [Creative Commons “No Rights reserved” \(CC0\)](#).

We denote by “user” any person accessing, using, exchanging, downloading, or submitting any type of content or information with, from and to FRS and all services it provides, interacting with FRS in any way, or holding or exercising any function within FRS.

The “work” refers to the material submitted to FRS and to the actual manuscript as publicly available on [arxiv.org](#) (“the arXiv”), as well as all supporting material, such as, but not limited to, appendices, supplementary information, a popular summary, datasets, computer code, images, plots, videos or other recordings that are transmitted or made available to FRS in order to assess the manuscript’s suitability for publication. This refers to both the manuscript and material present in the initial submission, as well as all further versions and additions of material in later resubmissions.

The “submitter” is anyone who carries out the submission of a work to FRS for publication, either through the provided online system or via email, and who is identified by their account in the online system or name and address used in the email. In case of multiple submitters, the definition applies in full to every single one of them.

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2. FQ_xI Foundational Review Series Scope and Editorial Criteria

2.1 *Philosophy and Scope*

The fundamental nature of physical reality remains a unique environment to probe the boundaries of current theoretical models. Traditional academic journal frameworks often prioritize incremental refinements of existing models. FQ_xI, however, is dedicated to catalyzing research that challenges the current foundations of physics. FQ_xI empowers authors to challenge deep-seated paradigms through rigorous mathematical and logical frameworks, supporting research that lies beyond the remit of traditional institutional support and investigates the underlying laws that govern our universe.

To this end, FQ_xI and FRS aim to create living reviews for foundational physics by providing works that are self-contained, and serve as repositories of the current state-of-the-art and accessible introductions for FQ_xI members, postdoctoral researchers, and graduate students in theoretical physics. Moreover, these manuscripts are envisioned as a space for authors to offer informed physics-based speculations from their own perspective.

FRS is a highly selective journal for high-impact living reviews of topics in foundational physics, broadly defined as research concerned with the most basic principles, concepts, and structures that underlie our understanding of physical reality. The scope of FRS therefore encompasses, but is not limited to, the following fields: quantum gravity, quantum foundations and information, cosmology (namely inflation, dark matter, dark energy, cosmological constant, fine-tuning, and multiverses), the nature of time, agency, and the role of AI in reshaping foundational physics.

2.2 *Editorial Criteria and Selection*

Since FRS is aiming to challenge and reform the current academic publishing framework by creating a journal that prioritizes the interests of participants and financially compensates them for their time, FRS must be a highly selective journal. Thus, FRS seeks to publish manuscripts that:

- addresses fundamentally significant questions within foundational physics that have broad implications for our understanding of the universe.
- clearly demonstrates a necessity for a standard reference on a foundational physics topic.
- synthesizes distinct research avenues into a cohesive, evidence-based framework. We explicitly exclude manuscripts that focus on marginal technical updates.
- summarizes the current state-of-the-art into a structured framework that clarifies open problems and promotes future advancement.

- provides a conceptual introduction to the topic of the manuscript that is accessible to other FQ_xI members and the advanced non-expert, ideally at the level of a theoretical physics graduate student. Technical insights should be presented in way that is analytically clear and can be understood by advanced non-experts without sacrificing rigor.
- maintains technical precision in their theoretical arguments. While we encourage the exploration of novel ideas, the underlying physics must be explicitly defined and mathematically sound.

Submissions that do not meet the above criteria will be not be considered.

3. Submission Process and Manuscript Preparation

3.1 Submission to FQ_xI Journals

It is strongly encouraged that authors prepare their manuscripts using the FQ_xI L^AT_EX template ([link to the Overleaf Template; coming to GitHub](#)). A Microsoft Word template is also available ([link to the Word Template; same deal as the Overleaf Template. They appear together so people can choose one or other and find them in one place](#)).

Authors are only required to submit a PDF of their manuscript to the FQ_xI platform upon their initial submission to the Foundational Review Series (FRS). Upon acceptance, in addition to the PDF, authors are required to submit the source files of their manuscript as this makes it easier to edit (especially during the subsequent proof-reading stage) and to extract information from the text for the FRS landing page for the manuscript.

Technical specifications of the manuscript include:

- Graphics in the manuscript are allowed to have `.eps`, `.pdf`, `.jpg` (with sufficient resolution), and `.png` (also with sufficient resolution of 300 dpi or greater) extensions.
- Figures must be high-resolution and captions should be self-contained and descriptive.
- Illustrative figures are encouraged where applicable. For an initial submission, informative place holders or sketches are acceptable. If accepted for publication, FQ_xI will commission a professional illustrator to make said illustrative figures.
- We encourage the use of colorblind-friendly color palettes or that there be an alternative way to understand plots for those with colorblindness. For instance, suppose there is a plot of x vs. y for multiple values of some parameter z , one can define each line of z by a different color and a different line-style. This way, one can either understand the plot by the colors or the by the line-style.
- For L^AT_EX users, the use of a BibT_EX file (i.e., a `.bib` file) is preferred. Furthermore, all custom macros must be defined in the preamble of the manuscript and not in a separate, external `.sty` file.

- Equations and tables must be constructed within the manuscript and not be embedded as images. For both Microsoft Word and $\text{\LaTeX}$ users, equations and tables should use standard the $\text{\LaTeX}$ table and equation environments, respectively.

3.2 Manuscript Structure

Manuscripts should have the following elements:

• Title page and Abstract

- The title page should have the title of the manuscript, name(s) of the author(s), author(s) affiliations, ORCID, and a footnote with author(s) email. It is not required that all authors have their email in the footnote, but we require at least the email of the corresponding author.
- The abstract should summarize the problem and state the specific the foundational physics question being addressed, as well as the scope of the literature reviewed.
- The title page and abstract should appear together on the same page.

• Table of Contents

- Must come on the page immediately after the title page and abstract.

• Main Text

- Each section (not including the Introduction, the Conclusion, and the individual sub-sections of the section at hand) should have a summary of the main point(s) that the reader should take away from the section. These sentences should be separated from the last paragraph of the section and started with **Bottom Line:**. An example is shown in both the Overleaf and Microsoft Word.
- It is encouraged that authors have some text discussing the next 5-10 years of research in the foundational physics topic of the review. Moreover, authors are also encouraged to have some text speculating on any aspect of the review topic from their informed perspective.

• Acknowledgments

- Acknowledgments of funding sources, FQxI grant numbers (if applicable), and any other note worthy acknowledgments (e.g., thanking the referees for their valuable feedback or anyone who provided feedback on the manuscript prior to submission).

• Appendices

- Appendices must come after the Acknowledgments and before the References.

- Appendices must be labeled with a letter and not a number. For instance, the section heading should be, “A. Section Title.” This is easily done using the FQ_xI FRS template provided on our site.

• References

- Citations and bibliographies must be in accordance with the Chicago Manual of Style, utilizing either the Author-Year system or the Notes and Bibliography system (informally referred to as the sequentially numbered citation system). For L^AT_EX users, the given template provides both choices in the preamble of the `main.tex` file by selecting `sequential-numbered` (Notes and Bibliography System) or `author-year` (Author-Year) arguments for the `fqxi-foundational-review` package. For Microsoft Word users, you can use both by doing the following:

- * **For the Author-Date system:** Navigate to the **References** tab, select **Style: Chicago** from the dropdown menu, and use the **Insert Citation** tool to place parenthetical markers and automatically generate the final bibliography.
- * **For the Notes and Bibliography system:** Because Word’s built-in citation tool does not natively automate Chicago-style numbered notes linked to a bibliography, it is highly recommended to use a free reference manager like Zotero or Mendeley with its respective Word add-in. Alternatively, you must manually insert footnotes via the **References > Insert Footnote** tool and manually construct an alphabetized bibliography at the end of your document.

3.3 Mathematics, Notation, and Units

- All mathematical expressions must be typeset in L^AT_EX. This can be done in Microsoft Word by ensuring that L^AT_EX is selected in the conversions section of the equation environment.
- Equations should be numbered sequentially with Arabic numerals in parentheses (e.g., Eq. (1) or Equation (1)). Embedding equations as static images is strictly prohibited to ensure high-fidelity rendering and accessibility. For complex derivations or multi-step proofs, equations should be referenced explicitly by number to maintain a linear, evidence-based approach.
- Notation must be applied consistently throughout the manuscript. All variables, operators, and parameters must be explicitly defined upon their first instance in the text. Authors utilizing non-standard symbolic frameworks or specialized indices must provide a comprehensive definition or reference an established mathematical foundation to eliminate ambiguity. Standard academic conventions (e.g., Einstein summation) may be employed without explicit definition, provided their application is unambiguous within the mathematical context of the work.

- Physical quantities and conventions must be stated clearly and consistently (unless explicitly said otherwise) throughout the text.
- All variables and physical constants must be clearly and concisely defined upon first use in the manuscript.

3.4 Length Guidelines

While there is no strict length required for FRS, manuscripts are typically asked to be between 20-30 pages, not including references.

3.5 Open Access and Publication Fees

To make scientific publishing more beneficial to researchers, as well as to make it more accessible to all, there are no fees associated with publishing in FRS. Furthermore, all manuscripts published in FRS will be made open access on FQxI's main site.

3.6 Data Availability

If applicable to the manuscript and ethically feasible,

- Authors must include a Data Availability Statement specifying where raw data and/or code can be accessed
- It is recommended that, where possible, any used code or raw data are archived in repositories like Zenodo or GitHub for long-term storage. This includes codes for visualizations.

3.7 Submission Agreement and Certification

All contributors to the manuscript, including authors, referees, illustrators, and FQxI staff, pledge to uphold the FQxI FRS **Terms and Conditions** (Sec. 6) and **FQxI Code of Conduct** (Sec. 6.1). At FQxI, we are committed to fostering a professional environment characterized by scientific integrity, equality, transparency, and mutual respect.

By submitting your manuscript to FQxI, you certify that:

- *Authorization*: You have obtained explicit consent from all co-authors and relevant stakeholders to submit this work to FQxI.
- *Copyright Integrity*: The submission is original and does not infringe upon the intellectual property rights of any third party.
- *Liability*: You accept full legal and financial responsibility for any claims arising from copyright infringement related to this material.

- *Exclusivity*: This work is not currently under review elsewhere and has not been previously published in another journal.
- *Submission Ethics*: You agree not to submit this work to any other venue while it is under active consideration by FQ_xI, unless a final rejection notice has been issued.

3.8 Artificial Intelligence and Large Language Model policy

Manuscripts (including any images, audio, or text) must not be created entirely or mostly with artificial intelligence (AI) tools, unless the author(s) informs FQ_xI and FRS in writing before submitting it. If the FRS finds AI-generated content that was not disclosed, FRS may reject the manuscript or ask for changes. This does not ban using AI tools for basic editing, such as grammar, spelling, or formatting. Any utilization of AI in the data collection, analysis, or manuscript drafting must be transparently disclosed in the Acknowledgments, detailing the specific tool used, version number, and the scope of its application.

It is sole and exclusive responsibility of the authors for the integrity, accuracy, and originality of their entire manuscript. The use of AI or AI-assisted technologies does not diminish this responsibility. Any errors, factual inaccuracies, or ethical breaches are on the authors, regardless of whether they were generated by AI. For full details regarding FQ_xI's AI usage policy, please refer the author contract if you are an author/co-author, the reviewer contract if you are a referee, and the publishing agreement if you are a creative professional contracted by FQ_xI.

3.9 Pre-print Policy

Authors may simultaneously submit their manuscripts to both arXiv (see <https://arxiv.org/>) and FRS. Following formal FRS review and editorial processing, authors are encouraged to update their arXiv pre-prints to reflect the peer-reviewed text and scientific corrections to make the pre-print as scientifically accurate as possible. While authors are expected to update their text to match the final accepted version, specific visual illustrations commissioned by FQ_xI, such as professional illustrations or custom informative graphics, may not be uploaded to arXiv. Authors must use their own original figures and diagrams in the arXiv pre-print version. Upon formal publication on the FRS platform, author must update their arXiv metadata to include the official citation and a direct link to the manuscript's open-access landing page on the FQ_xI FRS Platform.

4. Peer-Review Process

4.1 Overview and approximate timeline

Upon submission, the timeline for a typical peer-review process in FRS goes in the following way

- 229 • It takes the Coordinating Editor about **one to two weeks** to initially screen the manuscript
 230 for scope and the editorial criteria, as well as to invite the external referees. It then may
 231 take an **additional two weeks** for a referee to accept or decline a review, which may
 232 extend the timeline on the order of weeks.
- 233 • Once 2-3 external referees are invited and agree to the review, FRS expects to receive
 234 a review report about **a month** once they receive the manuscript. While FRS does
 235 financially compensate the referees for their time, FRS respects the referees' time, and
 236 kindly ask authors for patience at this stage. Moreover, referees are full time researchers
 237 and their work for FRS might not be recognized by their institutions or grant giving
 238 institutions. As a result of this, it may take **longer than a month** for a referee to get
 239 their report back to the Coordinating Editor. Lastly, during the month in which the
 240 referees have the manuscript, the Coordinating Editor is also reviewing the manuscript
 241 to provide feedback from the advanced non-expert point of view.
- 242 • Upon receiving the referees' and Editor's feedback, FRS typically gives the authors about
 243 **two months** to respond. FRS also respects the authors' time, thus delays can also appear
 244 at this point in the process. Authors are financially compensated for their invited reviews,
 245 which should mitigate delays here, but again, their institutions or funding agencies might
 246 not acknowledge the compensation from FRS and still have deadlines on the authors as
 247 well.
- 248 • Once the authors address the editorial and referee feedback, and resubmit their manuscript,
 249 the Coordinating Editor decides whether the paper should be 1) the manuscript should
 250 be accepted for publication, if there are only grammatical/stylistic comments left and
 251 the current changes are satisfactory or 2) Sent back to the referees if the responses to the
 252 referees' feedback need to be checked by referees' themselves. In the event of 2), we give
 253 the referees **another month** to look over the revised manuscript.
- 254 • In the copyediting phase, either the Coordinating Editor or a contracted external copy-
 255 editor will read the manuscript for grammatical errors. This process may take **over a**
 256 **month**, especially if the manuscript is sent to an external copyeditor.
- 257 • Throughout all of these steps, FRS will be working with the author and an independent
 258 professional illustrator to create a banner illustration for the manuscript's landing page,
 259 and possibly illustrating conceptual figures for the manuscript. While this process is
 260 started as early as when the manuscript is sent to the reviewers, the creation of these
 261 illustrations may stretch beyond the copyediting phase of the manuscript, depending
 262 on the level of detail and the number of illustrations assigned to the illustrator for the
 263 manuscript.
- 264 • Depending on if the referees determine if some calculations need to be verified, FRS
 265 will contract and pay for independent verifiers (usually a postdoc or advanced graduate
 266 student) to redo the specified results in the manuscript. However, a manuscript may be

published on the FRS site before the calculations are verified, but FRS will make clear to the reader which calculations were flagged by the referees.

For a standard paper that doesn't hit extreme delays, but goes through the normal back-and-forth, a realistic average timeline from submission to publication would be about 6-7 months.

4.2 Editorial Review and First Decision

If your manuscript is invited to submit to FRS, it will firstly be sent directly to the Coordinating Editor. Here, the manuscript will be processed using FQ_xI's Editorial platform to ensure computability, and to score sections of the text for its novelty and objectivity. The Coordinating Editor will review the manuscript for adherence to the scope and the level of presentation quality that is expected at FRS (see Sec. 2 for further details on scope and editorial criteria).

4.3 External Peer-Review

If the manuscript passes these initial screens, the Coordinating Editor will invite 2-3 external referees, who are experts to review the paper. The review process will primarily go about the usual way. However, during the review, FRS will have a platform in which authors and referees can anonymously communicate (with the Coordinating Editor being able to view all conversations) with one another to address any misunderstandings about the material and any other minor feedback. The goal of this platform, is to help consolidate the formal review to only having critical points of feedback.

An additional piece of the peer-review process that will differ from the traditional format is that FRS asks referees to flag statements or calculations that they believe should be verified. In these cases, an independent scientist, such as a graduate student or postdoctoral fellow, will be contracted to reproduce the result and note any differences arising between their approach and the authors. These independent scientists will also be given substantial (non-author) credit for their work. Finally, FRS also kindly asks referees for any suggestions on possible independent verifiers for the claims.

Once the External peer-review process is completed, all formal reviews by the referees will appear along side the published manuscript, and the referees will be accredited for their contribution to reviewing the manuscript. However, it is entirely the choice of the referee if they wish to name themselves or remain anonymous at any point during the process. Please see Sec. 4.9 for further details.

Finally, referees should disclose any potential conflicts of interest related to a manuscript and, when appropriate, recuse themselves. Potential conflicts include close collaboration with the author(s), personal relationships, directly competing research, affiliation with the same institution, and financial ties. If a referee believes they may have a potential conflict for the manuscript, please immediately inform the Coordinating Editor so they and the FRS team can assess its impact on the review. In some cases, given the niche nature of a topic, FRS may be able to waive minor conflicts, but they will be made clear in the review appearing with

the published manuscript. If a conflict arises at any point during the review, please contact the Coordinating Editor promptly. A competing interest is any external interest that could reasonably be seen as undermining (or appearing to undermine) your ability to provide an unbiased, professional review.

4.4 Editorial Review

Simultaneously while the external peer review process is underway, the Coordinating Editor will also be reviewing the manuscript from the perspective of an advanced non-expert in the field. The goal of the Coordinating Editor at this stage is to provide feedback on concepts that are not easily understood, calculations that might need a bit more detail or explanation, on the organization on the ideas presented, and give possible ideas for helpful illustrations that might better convey a point the author is trying to make.

4.5 Illustrations

All manuscripts will be given a banner illustration for the landing page of their manuscript on FQxI's site. Therefore, FRS will contract a professional illustrator to do this task. If the manuscript has figures that could be better illustrated or a new idea for an illustration is agreed upon by the author and Coordinating Editor, an Illustrator (most likely the same one who is illustrating the banner for the landing page) will also be contracted to do these illustrations as well. Authors will work with the Coordinating Editor and Illustrator to discuss the design and ideas of the illustrations. This process will require several versions of the illustrations, as well as (possibly) multiple online meetings between the author(s), Illustrator, and Coordinating Editor.

Illustrators will be clearly accredited by having their name and webpage (if they have one) linked in the captions of the figures that they illustrated within in the manuscript. Furthermore, they will also be clearly credited with the banner illustration that will appear on the landing page of the published manuscript.

4.6 Statement and Calculation Verification

If a reviewer flags a statement or calculation that needs to be verified (i.e., not standard within the field topic of the manuscript), FRS will contract an independent verifier to valid the statement(s) and/or calculations(s). FRS asks reviewers to suggest independent verifiers who are postdoctoral fellows or advanced graduate students. The independent verifier will not only be financially compensated for their time and efforts, but they will also be substantial non-author level credit in the manuscript with their names appearing below the author field of the text. The results of these verifiers will be linked to the specific statement(s) and/or calculation(s) in which they checked. These results will not only contain the step-by-step reasoning of the verifier, but they will also highlight any discrepancies between their results and that of the author's(s').

Please note that a manuscript may still be published while the independent verification is still underway. In this event, FRS will clearly indicate in the published version of the living review which parts of the texts are being independently verified.

4.7 Copyediting

After a manuscript has passed the external peer-review and editorial review phases, it will then be copyedited for readability, clarity, flow, and grammar. Depending on the availability of the Coordinating Editor, either they will copyedit the text or FQ_xI will contract an external copyeditor. These edits will be returned to the author(s), with the copyedits appears in red in the text. Once all changes have been completed and approved by the author(s), the manuscript is ready to be published on it's landing page on the FRS main page.

If a copyeditor is contracted to edit the manuscript, they will be acknowledged and credited for their work in the manuscript.

4.8 Updates to FRS living review manuscripts

Since the reviews invited to be published in FRS are living documents, it will be expected that the manuscripts will need to be revised continuously. For every update, there will be a clear version control visible to readers so that they can see the current and previous versions of the review. It is the expectation that authors will commit to updating and improving their manuscripts as their understandings on the topic of the change.

4.9 Options of anonymity for authors and reviewers

At FRS, authors and reviewers have several options in regards to their anonymity. For authors, they may ask to be kept anonymous during the review process and to only have their identity revealed once the article is published. For reviewers, they may ask to be kept anonymous throughout the review process and to be anonymous once the manuscript is published. That is, as mentioned previously, they are able to choose if they would like to have their named published within the document and the manuscript. Therefore, for example, a referee may ask to remain anonymous while the peer-review process is underway, but may also identify themselves so that their name appears in the published manuscript and the review.

5. Authorship

It is essential that the appropriate credit is given to each individual who contributed to a manuscript. FRS holds all listed authors accountable for ensuring the accuracy, validity, reproducibility, and ethicality of their published manuscripts. In this section, we detail the authorship criteria, author contribution statements, the procedures for changed to the author list, and our name change policy.

5.1 Authorship Criteria

FRS strictly adheres to the recommendations established by the [Committee on Publication Ethics \(COPE\)](#). According to the [COPE definition glossary](#), authorship is defined as someone who has:

- significantly contributed to the conception of the research; or design of the research method; or the acquisition, analysis, or interpretation of data for the work; AND
- participated in drafting the manuscript or reviewing the work important intellectual content; AND
- given final approval of the version of the manuscript that is to be submitted and published; AND
- has agreed to be accountable for all aspects of the research, ensuring that any questions related to the accuracy or integrity of any parts of the work are appropriately investigated and resolved.

It is the collective responsibility of all authors to determine that all contributors who meet these requirements are appropriately listed, and that individuals who do not meet all four requirements are not included in the author list, but are appropriately credited in the acknowledgments section of the manuscript.

In accordance with COPE guidelines, AI, LLMs, or any related frameworks do not meet the criteria for authorship because they cannot take legal or ethical responsibility for the work. Please see [Sec. 3.8](#) for specific details on how to appropriately disclose the usage of AI or LLMs, and the responsibility of the authors with respect to their usage.

5.2 Author Contribution Statements

Authors must take full responsibility for the content and be able to identify which co-authors are responsible for specific parts of the work. Therefore, to ensure transparency, all accepted multi-author manuscripts must include a formal Author Contribution Statement prior to final publications. FRS follows the [Contributor Roles Taxonomy \(CRediT\)](#) framework, under [Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International \(CC BY 4.0\)](#), and requires authors to use the 14 distinct contributor roles.

During the final submission, the corresponding author is responsible for ensuring that the role descriptions of each author are accurate and are agreed upon by all listed authors. Authors may be listed across multiple roles, and multiple authors may share a single role. The author contribution statement will be published in the final version of the manuscript as a block of text following the Acknowledgments.

An example format is given below:

Author Contributions: *Author A:* Conceptualization, Methodology, Writing – Original Draft. *Author B:* Data Curation, Software, Formal Analysis. *Author C:* Validation, Investigation,

Writing – Review & Editing. *Author D*: Funding Acquisition, Project Administration, Resources, Supervision.

5.3 Changes to Authorship

The list of authors and the designated corresponding author initially submitted to FRS is considered final. Any request to alter the list of authors in anyway or change the corresponding author after submission, but prior to final publication, must be formally requested by the corresponding author an agreed upon by all original authors listed on the initial submission to FRS.

To request a modification, the corresponding must submit the request to the Coordinating Editor via a signed **Authorship Change Form** ([link to the form](#); [should I make one for people to submit to or can we have Tom/someone make a standard FQ_xI form?](#)). This document must include:

- A written justification clearly detailing the scientific or logical reason for the addition, removal, or reordering of names; AND
- written confirmation (via direct email or physical/digital signature) from all original authors confirming their explicit agreement with the proposed authorship change; AND
- written confirmation by any new author being added, verifying that they fulfill all four criteria specified in Sec. 5.1.

FRS will halt the publication process (including peer-review) while an authorship change is actively evaluated. If an authorship dispute arises among the authors, FRS will strictly follow the [COPE flowcharts on authorship disputes](#). FRS will not arbitrate domestic disputes, and processing of the manuscript will be suspended until the authors provide an official, documented, and unified resolution.

5.4 Name Change Policy

FRS recognizes that authors may change their names during the course of their careers for a variety of deeply personal reasons. If your name has changed after your manuscript's publication, please email FRS and we will change it everywhere on our website and in our system.

To support exclusivity and preserve professional identities, FRS does not require legal proof, official documentation, or court orders to initiate a name change. Name change requests are handled with confidentiality and sensitivity. Moreover, to protect the privacy of the requesting author, name updates can processed retroactively so that no formal correction notice, manuscript version update, or erratum will be attached to the manuscript.

While, FRS can change the name on the paper's webpage, pdf, metadata, it's internal systems, and in the references of other papers that appear in the Series, we cannot easily change how it appears on the indexing platforms, such as Inspire or arXiv. We are happy to assist in helping author's change their names on these platforms, however.

6. Terms and Conditions

The entirety of this section is adapted and modified from the [Quantum Journal Terms and Conditions](#), available under [Creative Commons “No Rights reserved” \(CC0\)](#). While, the Code of Conduct (Sec. 6.1) and Conflict of Interest section (Sec.6.2) was informed by COPE’s guidance on [codes of conduct](#) and [conflicts of interest](#), respectively.

By submitting a manuscript, conducting a review, producing visual illustrations, or otherwise participating in the editorial production pipeline for FRS, all participating parties, namely Authors, Reviewers, Illustrators, Statement/Mathematical Evaluators, FQ_xI Editors, and all parties working with and/or for FQ_xI agree to following terms and conditions:

1. Authors have the permission of all co-authors and other right holders to pursue publication of the work in FRS.
2. Authors will not submit this work to any other publishing venue, including other journals and conference proceedings, unless it is terminally rejected by FRS.
3. All contributing parties warrant that any text, data, code, reviews, mathematical evaluations, or visual asses (e.g., sketches, diagrams, and illustrations), provided to FRS are original works and do not infringe on anyone’s copyright or intellectual property with the material contained in your work.
4. All contributing parties will be fully liable for any charges resulting from copyright infringement or intellectual property contained within their respective work submitted to FQ_xI and FRS.
5. FRS’ liability disclaimer, permitted third party use of content published by FQ_xI, and the rights of the authors/professional artists/reviewers/evaluators, are governed by their respective *Foundational Review Series Agreement*, which are sent to all participants invited to work with FRS. Please refer to this agreement for the full terms and conditions.
6. All contributing parties commit to follow the Code of Conduct laid out in Sec. 6.1. Violations may result in the immediate termination of contracts, honorariums, or publication privileges.

6.1 Code of Conduct

FQ_xI and FRS aim to create and foster an inclusive, respectful, and professional environment. All participants in the publication process (for example, but not limited to, authors, reviewers, illustrators, statement/mathematics evaluators, editors) are expected act in accordance with courtesy, respect, and in accordance with all principles described by the following code. Moreover, the following code applies during all interactions with FQ_xI and the entirety of the publication process from submission to post-publication correspondences.

6.1.1 Unacceptable behavior

Here, we detail behavior that FQ_xI and FRS deem unacceptable, both in interactions with both FQ_xI and FRS, and in professional life in general. Behaviors that are deemed unacceptable by FQ_xI and FRS are, but not limited to,

1. Plagiarism and fabrication of data and results, including misrepresentation of contributions and authorship, selective reporting, failure to promptly correct errors, or theft of data and/or other research materials, as well as misrepresentation and overstatement of results and the omission of crucial conditions and assumptions.
2. Publication (or submission for publication) of works submitted to or published in FRS to other publishing venues, unless the work is terminally rejected by FRS. “Other publishing venues,” include other journals and conference proceedings, but exclude public pre-print servers such as the arXiv and personal or institutional websites of the authors. Re-publication of excerpts, or the entirety of a work submitted to or published in FRS as part of a work with a broader scope, such as a review article or a thesis, is allowed with proper citation to the latest version of the FRS living review manuscript.
3. Subversion of peer-review, including failure to declare conflict of interest, submission of fraudulent reviewer suggestions (including the fabrication of reviewer identities, provision of false contact information for actual researchers, or the nominations of individuals who are not independent of the authors), failure to recuse under conflict of interest, misuse of information during review, unnecessarily delaying the peer-review process, violation of the anonymity of referees, premature solicitation of press coverage, corruption and/or bribery.
4. Impersonation of other persons or entities, as well as unrightfully claiming the ownership of scientific titles, professional positions, or affiliations.
5. Using FRS or any other system for the dissemination of scientific works to promote hate or discriminatory speech, or to infringe on the rights of others.
6. Sharing of confidential information, such as the identity of reviewers, referee reports, and other internal correspondence to persons not involved in the peer-review process.
7. Discrimination of any kind, such as on the basis of religion, disability, age, national origin, race, ethnicity, sexual orientation, gender identity, or gender expression. Discrimination includes the use of derogatory comments or slurs.
8. Harassment, including bullying and intimidation, black mail, personal attacks, false accusations, threats and assault, as well as sexual harassment in public or in private.
9. The violation of public trust, including making false or misleading statements, to media, and misrepresentation to grant and/or funding agencies.

- 515 10. Retaliation of any form against anyone who, in good faith, report suspected misconduct,
516 file a complaint, or cooperate with an investigation under this code. This includes, but
517 not limited to, unjustified negative reviews, exclusion, damage to career prospects, and
518 personal retaliation either in public or in private. All reporting that is done in good faith
519 is protected regardless of the outcome of the investigation.
- 520 11. Filing of misconduct allegations that are knowingly false or made in bad faith. This
521 includes the use of an allegation as an instrument of harassment, intimidation, or retalia-
522 tion against authors, reviewers, editors, illustrators, statement/mathematics evaluators,
523 or anyone involved in the publication process. Repeated or demonstrably bad faith
524 allegations will be treated as a violation of this code.

525 6.2 Conflict of Interest

526 All editors, reviewers, illustrators, statement/mathematics evaluators, authors, and any other
527 participant in the publication process must disclose any relationships, whether it be financial,
528 institutional, or personal, that could be reasonably perceived to undermine their ability to
529 perform their part of the publication process in an unbiased and professional way. Please note
530 that we are willing to waive some possible conflicts of interest due to the possible nicheness of
531 the review topic.

532 6.3 Reporting Violations and Possible Sanctions

533 FQ_xI and FRS may learn of violations through reports from witnesses or aggrieved individuals
534 and parties, including anonymous reports filed through the dedicated online form ([link to the
535 form; same deal as the authorship change form: Should I make a document or can we have Tom
536 make one?](#)). For the safety of all reporters, once a report has been made, FRS editors and FQ_xI
537 executive board members are bound to maintain the confidentiality of the report except as
538 explicitly requested by the reporting parties. Upon receiving a report, FRS will progress as
539 follows:

- 540 1. The Executive Board of FQ_xI and FRS editors will name an investigator or form a small
541 investigation body of no more than three people, each of whom must be free of conflicts
542 of interest.
- 543 2. The investigator, or investigating body, may solicit additional information from the
544 reporter, with the goal of reaching a tentative conclusion over the course of 30 days. Any
545 delays will be communicated with all pertinent parties.
- 546 3. The tentative conclusion of the investigating body will be delivered to the Executive
547 Board, along with a suggested resolution action as described below.
- 548 4. If the tentative conclusion and suggested resolution action are agreed upon by the
549 Executive Board, FRS will inform the reporter of their decision and seek agreement
550 before proceeding.

551 5. The party suspected of a violation of the code of conduct will be informed of the allega-
552 tions and planned resolution action and given 30 days to respond.

553 6. Depending on the findings, on communication from the involved parties, and consensus of
554 the Executive Board, the resolution action may be implemented or further investigations
555 carried out with the aim of resolving the situation.

556 During the reporting and investigating process, all individuals must exercise all due diligence
557 to prevent divulging any report details beyond those strictly necessary to enact and uphold
558 the code of conduct. In particular, if upon receiving an initial report, it is deemed the alleged
559 infraction would not result in a penalty more severe than a formal warning, the Executive Board
560 may decide to directly handle the report without the aid of an investigating body, provided
561 that no conflict of interest is introduced.

562 If a FRS user is found through the preceding process to have committed any violation
563 of the code of conduct, FRS may enforce the code of conduct in a number of different ways.
564 An appropriate resolution is decided by the Executive Board, taking into account all factors,
565 and having as a goal to improve the situation. Possible actions to enforce the code of conduct
566 include but are not limited to:

567 1. A formal (written) warning made to the infringing party.

568 2. Requiring the infringing party to make a formal (written) apology.

569 3. Reporting the infringing party to their home institutions, employers, and/or professional
570 societies.

571 4. Reporting the infringing party to the relevant authorities, in case of suspicion of criminal
572 offenses.

573 5. Retraction of compromised manuscripts (based on scientific reasons).

574 6. Refusal to consider future manuscripts from the infringing party.

575 7. Where applicable, expulsion from their FQ_xI membership.